

Sky Kunkel

June 11, 2026

✉ sk3386@cornell.edu

🌐 LinkedIn: skytheacademic

📍 123 Central Ave, 314, Ithaca, NY 14853

🗎 Pronouns: they/them

🐦 Twitter: @skytheacademic

🌐 www.skytheacademic.com

Academic Appointments, Positions, and Affiliations

Su. 2024- **Postdoctoral Research Associate**

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY

Gender and Security Sector Lab

AY 2023-24 **Peace Scholar Fellow**

United States Institute of Peace, Washington, DC

AY 2023-24 **Predoctoral Research Fellow**

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY

Gender and Security Sector Lab

Education

May 2024 **Ph.D. Political Science**

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

Fields: International Relations, Political Methodology

Dissertation: *The Local Effects of UN Peacekeeping*

- Finalist for College-wide Distinguished Dissertation Award

Committee Members: Kyle Haynes (Chair), Liana Eustacia Reyes, Giancarlo Visconti, Michael Greig

May 2019 **B.A. Political Science**

Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN

Research

* indicates a graduate student co-author; † indicates an external co-author

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- *†1. "Violence as a Condition: Structure, Composition, and the Use of Lethal Force" (with Matthew Kyle Ellis). *Journal of Conflict Resolution*. OnlineFirst. 1-26. 📄
 - Requested by United States Congressional Research Service for distribution.
- †2. "Here Today, Gone Tomorrow: Dynamics of Peacekeeper Entry and Exit on Violence Against Civilians" (with Douglas B. Atkinson, Rebecca Dudley, and Zach Warner). *Accepted, International Political Science Review*. 📄

In-Progress

1. "Who Keeps the Peace? Gendered Effects in UN Peacekeeping". *R&R, International Studies Quarterly*. 📄
 - ISA Midwest Lynne Rienner Award
 - ISA IO Section Finkelstein Prize Special Mention
- *†2. "What's in a Name? Implications of Overusing 'Sub-Saharan Africa'" (with Mitushi Mukherjee). *R&R, International Studies Perspectives*.

3. | “Double Delegation: An Exploration and Construction of the UN Private Security Contractor Database”. *Working Paper*. 
4. | “All About that Base... No Trouble. The Gravity of Peacekeeping Bases”. *Working Paper*. 
- *†5. | “Beyond Negative Peace: Do UN Peacekeepers decrease security and trust concerns?” (with Catalina Vega-Méndez). *Work in progress*.
- *†6. | “Alexander or Ozymandias?: Russia’s PMC Driven Foreign Policy in Africa” (with Matthew Kyle Ellis). *Work in progress*.

Non Peer-Reviewed Publications

- *†1. | “Moving Beyond Zero Tolerance: Preventing Sexual Exploitation, Abuse, and Harassment in UN Peace Operations,” 2024. Sabrina Karim, **Sky Kunkel**, DeAnne Roark, Angie Torres-Beltran, Cameron Mailhot, Sumin Lee, Radwa Saad, Priscilla Torres, and Emily Jackson. *GSS Lab Policy Brief*. 
- *†2. | “The Transition Home: Key Challenges for African UN Peacekeepers Upon Return,” 2024. Sabrina Karim, Maggie Dwyer, Addison Barton, T. Debey Sayndee, **Sky Kunkel**, Mike Kriner, and Clair MacDougall. *GSS Lab Policy Brief*. 

Other Publications

1. | “Women, Peace, and Participation,” in the *Handbook on Gender and Development: Critical Engagements with Gender and Social Justice*, Edited by Nitya Rao, Jasmine Gideon, Ulrike Theuerkauf, Shannon Philip. Forthcoming 2027, Palgrave Macmillan London.
2. | “More Than Presence: Gendered Dynamics of Interpreting and Negotiating Trust,” (with DeAnne Roark and Hatti Sellers) in the *Oxford Handbook of Interpreting UN Peacekeeping*, Edited by Vanessa Newby and Chiara Ruffa. Forthcoming 2027, Oxford University Press.

Fellowships and Grants

External (\$24993)

- 2024/25 | PolMeth Travel Grant, \$1500
- 2024 | URI Human Rights Workshop Honorarium, \$1000
- 2023 | USIP Peace Scholar Stipend (declined), \$20000
- 2023 | MapleMeth Travel Grant, \$500
- 2023 | ISA Midwest Travel Grant, \$250
- 2023 | APSA Conflict Processes Award, \$143
- 2022/23 | APSA Travel Grant, \$300
- 2022/25 | ISA Travel Grant, \$1300

Internal - Purdue University (\$34500)

- 2023-24 | Kruhe Fellow (declined), \$28000
- 2023 | Best Prospectus Award, \$1000

2022/23	PROMISE Research/Travel Award, \$3750
2022/23	Department Travel Grant, \$1250
2020-21	Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, \$500

Invited Talks and Workshops

Summer 2026	International Policy Summer Institute (<i>Host:</i> Bridging the Gap)
24/25/26	Human Rights Measurement Workshop (<i>Host:</i> University of Rhode Island Consortium for Rights Analysis and Measurement)
PSS(I) 24/25	Consortium for Human Rights Analysis and Measurement
Fall 2024	Gender and Peace Operations Conference (<i>Host:</i> International Peace Institute)
Fall 2024	Online Peace Science Colloquium
ISA 2024	Contractors in Great Power Competition: Challenging World Order in an Age of Privatization
PSS(I) 2023	New Research about Preventing Mass Atrocities (<i>Host:</i> United States Holocaust Memorial Museum)
Spring 2023	Junior Scholars in International Security Workshop
21/22/23	How to Research and Use the Purdue Libraries: Workshop and Presentation (<i>Host:</i> Purdue Political Science Graduate Welcome Week)
Fall 2022	Midwest Workshop in Empirical Political Science

Teaching Experience, Training, and Awards

Instructor of Record

Summer 21/22	POL 237 - Modern Weapons and International Relations
Summer 2023	POL 430 - UN Peacekeeping

Teaching Assistant - Graduate Courses/Workshops

Spring 2023	POL 605 - Advanced Causal Inference (Dr. Tara Grillos)
Fall 2022	POL 501 - Political Science Methodology (Dr. Joan Timoneda)
Spring 2022	POL 605 - Advanced Causal Inference (Dr. Giancarlo Visconti)
Summer 2024	CCSE Video Research Institute (Dr. Bryce J. Dietrich)

Teaching Assistant - Undergraduate Courses

Sp. 20/21/23, Fa. 20/21	POL 237 - Modern Weapons and International Relations (Dr. Keith Shimko)
Fall 2022	POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations (Dr. Kyle Haynes)
Spring 2022	POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations (Dr. Reed Kurtz)
Summer 2020	POL 237 - Modern Weapons and International Relations (Dr. Toby Lauterbach)
Fall 2019	POL 237 - Modern Weapons and International Relations (Clinical Professor Melissa Will)

Pedagogical Training

Summer 2021	Certificate in Foundations of College Teaching <i>Foundations of College Teaching Purdue University</i>
-------------	---

Teaching Awards

AY 2020-21	Outstanding Teaching Assistant <i>Department-wide award</i>
------------	---

Conference Participation

(C)=Chair, (D)=Discussant, (O)=Panel organizer, (P)=Panel participant, (R)=Roundtable, (Wo)=Workshop Organizer, (Wp)=Workshop Participant. ISA | 2022 (P), 2023 (P), 2024 (O, P, R, Wp), 2025 (C, O, P), 2026 (P, Wo)

APSA | 2022 (P), 2023 (D, P), 2024 (P, C), 2025 (P)

Peace Science | 2022 (P), 2023 (P, Wp), 2024 (Wp), 2025 (P, Wp)

PolMeth | 2022 (P), 2024 (P), 2025 (P)

MPSA | 2023 (D, P)

BISA | 2023 (P)

ISA-MW | 2023 (P)

ISA Virtual | 2023 (D, P)

MapleMeth | 2023 (P)

EGEN | 2023 (P)

Service

Department - Purdue

AY 2020-24	Political Science Mentorship Program <i>First-year Graduate Student Mentor</i>
------------	--

AY 2023-24	Graduate Student Government <i>Mentorship and Recruiting Chair</i>
------------	--

Fall 2023	First-Year Welcome Week Orientation <i>Organizer</i>
-----------	--

AY 2022-23	Technology and Politics Faculty Search Committee <i>Member</i>
------------	--

AY 2022-23	Graduate Student Government <i>Social Science Mechanics Chair</i>
------------	---

AY 2020-22	Graduate Student Government <i>Treasurer</i>
------------	--

Fall 2019	Devin Roberson Memorial Award Selection Committee <i>Member</i>
-----------	---

University - Purdue

Sp. 2023	Queer Graduate Student Association <i>Co-Founder, Inaugural President</i>
AY 2021-2023	LGBTQ+ Center <i>Undergraduate Tutor - Political Science, Methods/Statistics, R, Stata, $\LaTeX$</i>
Summer 2022	Liberal Arts Space Planning Committee <i>Graduate Student Representative</i>
Fall 2021	Undergraduate Research Conference <i>Judge/Reviewer</i>
Fall 2021	Interdisciplinary Symposium in Liberal Arts <i>Reviewer</i>

Discipline

Sp. 2026-28	ISA International Organization (IO) Section <i>Executive Committee Member-at-Large</i>
Su. 2022-25	Junior IO Scholars Workshop <i>Executive Council Member</i>
Fall 2022	International Studies Association - Northeast <i>Panel Moderator</i>
Summer 2022	Junior IO Scholars Workshop <i>Founding Member</i>

Reviewer: *The Journal of Politics, International Organization, International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Conflict Resolution, International Interactions, International Peacekeeping*

Skills and Experiences

Fieldwork: Fiji (2025; 2026)

Software: R, Stata, Python, Git, $\LaTeX$, Qualtrics, Docker

Learning Management Systems: Blackboard, Brightspace

References

Kyle Haynes

Associate Professor, Department of Political Science

Purdue University

✉ kylehaynes@purdue.edu

Sabrina Karim

Associate Professor, Department of Government

Cornell University

✉ smk349@cornell.edu

Giancarlo Visconti

Assistant Professor, Department of Government and Politics

University of Maryland, College Park

✉ gvis@umd.edu